1.2 | OVERVIEW (30 MIN)

REMINDER OF PROGRAMME STRUCTURE AND CONTENT

Share the overall objective of the programme that you introduced during the pre-programme individual consultation.

Ask participants to remind each other:

1. How many sessions will we have together?
2. What topics will we cover?
3. How do we meet?

Ensure that all components of the programme are mentioned, and emphasise the importance of how the various sessions can add value for participants.

Remind participants when they will meet in person and when they will meet online.
This is an important moment to get participants excited to attend the entire programme!

GROUND RULES – THINGS THAT WILL HELP US WORK TOGETHER

Establish Ground Rules to help make the programme a safe place to learn together. Ask participants to think what is important for them to feel comfortable and respected, and to feel safe and supported in the group.

Mayor Konektà is a special programme! It brings caregivers together to learn and share common experiences of parenting with each other. It is important that the group sets ground rules on how they will ensure that their time and experiences together are fruitful. These rules should be developed as a group and owned by the group.

Ground rules are also useful for helping you to run these sessions as facilitators. They can be helpful when reminding participants that **they** created the rules for how the sessions should be run.

When discussing Ground Rules, you can use the following format:

- Put up two flipchart papers and write at the top:
    - "Ground rules for online chat sessions"
    - "Ground rules for in-person sessions"
- Ask participants to share their suggestions.
- Write rules and comments on the flip chart and take photos of the final set of rules.

  Please note: You can add more ground rules to the lists later in the session when participants have a better understanding of the programme components.
- **Make sure Ground Rules describe a positive behaviour.** For example, rather than have a rule for in-person sessions of 'Don't talk on your phone

during the group session,' the rule can be 'Keep your phone on silent mode and take any urgent phone calls outside of the training room.'

- You can prompt participants for rules on specific issues like arriving on time, cell phone use, respect, confidentiality, etc.
- You can repeat back what you hear and explore the rules to make sure everyone in the group agrees and understands. For example, if someone mentions "Respect", ask what that means to her or him. What sort of behaviour shows "Respect"?
- Make sure everyone agrees and has the opportunity to contribute before moving on to another suggestion.

Some helpful ground rules may include:

You can add these after the participants have shared their own rules (now or later in the session when participants learn more about the programme components).

Ground rules for in-person sessions:

- Cell phones are turned off or kept on silent mode.
- Everyone will have an opportunity to share and practise.

Ground rules for online chat sessions:

- Ensure you have an Internet package that allows you to join the chat sessions.
- Respect the privacy of personal pictures and videos that are sent to the chat group.
- Join the live chat sessions at the agreed upon time.

Ground rules that could be on either the chat session or in-person session paper:

- Come on time and make the decision to try to participate in every session.
- If you cannot attend, please tell the facilitator beforehand or send a text message.
- Everyone is different and will have different experiences to share.
- Respect each other by paying attention and taking turns to share and listen.
- What we say in the group, stays in the group – both in-person and online.
- Share only what you feel comfortable to share.
- Feel free to ask any questions!

PLEASE NOTE! Save the Ground Rules and display them on the wall in the room for both of the in-person sessions and share photos of the ground rules in the WhatsApp chat group.

CONFIDENTIALITY

Ensure that confidentiality is part of the ground rules:

Keeping confidentiality: It is important right at the beginning to be clear about what is okay to share with others outside the group and what is not:

> Explain that in the Mayor Konektà programme, we come together to share experiences about our families. In order to ensure that everybody feels comfortable enough to participate in the group, it is important to trust that our personal stories – especially the things that we feel are challenging – will not be repeated outside the group. Of course sharing new learning and positive information is absolutely fine!

Breaking confidentiality: It is also important to note that confidentiality can be breached in cases where a participant discloses or shows evidence of serious physical, sexual or emotional abuse or exploitation, or threats of such harm.

Explain that a facilitator needs to break confidentiality if there is an attempt or threat of self-harm or suicide and potential serious harm to others. When this happens, the facilitator will talk to that person in private and both can seek help from a supervisor or local service provider (ensure you have the details for relevant local referral services).

PARENT GOALS – WHY ARE WE HERE?

After establishing Ground Rules for working together, allow parents to introduce themselves to each other and share the goals that were mentioned during the individual phone call before the in-person group sessions.

Each parent should have thought of a **specific, positive, and realistic** goal after the individual phone call that you did with them before the group sessions began .

During this part of the activity, parents have the opportunity to share these goals with each other. They may even notice that they have similar goals.

It is also okay if a parent would like to change his/her goal. Just make sure that the goal is **positive, specific, and realistic.** When listening to the parents' goals, ask yourself:

- Is the goal worded in a positive way?
- Does it describe a specific behaviour?
- Can it be achieved during the course of the programme?

If the goals are negative, vague, or impractical, use open-ended questions to guide the parent to a more appropriate goal.

Just like during the Ground Rules discussion, one of you should lead the activity while the other facilitator takes notes on the flipchart.

During this activity, parents are encouraged to:

1. Introduce themselves
2. Share their target child's name and age
3. Share their personal goal for the programme that they established during the individual calls before the group sessions began.

You can also tell parents that it is okay if their goals change over the course of the programme.

Whenever you realise that a parent has achieved her/his goal, you should bring attention to this wonderful accomplishment with lots of praise.

You can also ask the parent what s/he thinks helped him/her achieve this goal. Then set a new goal with the parent!

NOTE:

All the goals should be recorded on a flipchart and then reviewed after the group sharing. Sometimes, parents will share similar goals or discover something new!

REFRESHMENT BREAK (15 MIN)